

Certified Implementation Specialist – Data Foundations (CMDB and CSDM) Exam Specification

1. Introduction & Purpose

Exam Code: CIS-DF (CMDB and CSDM)

The **ServiceNow Data Foundations (CMDB and CSDM) Exam** certifies that a candidate possesses the skills and knowledge required to successfully design, implement, and operationalize a ServiceNow CMDB that supports the Common Service Data Model (CSDM) framework.

2. Target Audience

This certification is designed for ServiceNow customers, partners, employees, and practitioners responsible for CMDB health and CSDM alignment.

Key Job Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
CMDB Administrator	Administer and govern CMDB data.
CMDB Librarian / Data Steward	Implement continuous improvement processes for the CMDB.
Configuration Manager	Configure and review data (CMDB Workspace, Data Foundations Dashboard, Reports) to remediate issues and improve health.
CI Class Owner	Perform regular audits and data validation for accuracy and completeness.
Platform Architect / Owner	Design, configure, and ensure successful CMDB implementation.
Technical Consultant / Developer	Design, configure, and ensure successful CMDB implementation.

3. Recommended Experience & Prerequisites

While there are no hard prerequisites, the following experience level is highly recommended:

- **Certification:** Certified System Administrator (CSA).
- **Experience:** 2+ years with CMDB.
- **Key Skills:**
 - Foundational knowledge of the CSDM model.
 - Populating data in the CMDB and managing duplicate CIs.
 - Remediation of compliance audit failures.
 - Addressing CI lifecycle processes (retiring/archiving).
 - Familiarity with multi-source / CMDB 360.
 - Familiarity with ServiceNow products that leverage CMDB (ITSM, CSM, etc.).

4. Exam Scope & Domains

Total Questions: 75 | **Duration:** 90 Minutes

Domain	Weight	Objectives & Sub-Skills
1. Configuration	15%	• Use CI Class Manager (table, class attributes, hierarchy). • Use Identification and Reconciliation Engine (IRE). • Configure CMDB 360/multisource CMDB.
2. Ingest	19%	• Identify auto vs. manual relationship population. • Automate CMDB integrations. • Select data ingestion methods. • Minimize technical debt and ensure upgradeability.

		• Manage non-discoverable/manual CIs and attributes. • Track security/regulatory compliance against CSDM objects. • Asset and CI alignment.
3. Govern	35%	• CMDB Health Score: 6 metrics characteristics. • Data Manager: Purpose, requirements, and policy features. • Governance: Goals, key roles, and operationalization. • Health Dashboards: Configuration for KPIs and CSFs. • Duplication: Identification, remediation, and Deduplication Wizard. • CMDB Workspace: Features and usage. • Principal Classes: Definition and usage. • Data Quality: Validation via Health Dashboard & Data Foundation Dashboard. • Lifecycle: Managing CI attributes.

4. Insight	20%	• Business value of CMDB. • Natural Language Query (NLQ) usage. • CMDB 360: Building custom reports/Saved Queries. • Complex Relationships: Unified Map, dependency view map, complex queries. • Product Usage: Outcomes of products leveraging CMDB. • Playbooks: Benefits and usage of CMDB Foundation Dashboard Playbooks.
5. CSDM Fundamentals	11%	• Stakeholder collaboration for correct CI mapping to CSDM domains. • Approach to abiding by CSDM. • Benefits of implementing CSDM.

5. Preparation Resources

ServiceNow recommends the following official training paths:

Core Training:

- ServiceNow Administration Fundamentals
- Get Started with Now Create
- ServiceNow Platform Implementation
- CMDB Fundamentals
- Common Service Data Model (CSDM Fundamentals)

Simulators & Micro-Certs:

- CMDB Health Micro-Certification Simulator
- Configure the CMDB Micro-Certification Simulator

Additional Deep Dives:

- CMDB Health Deep Dive
- Introduction to CMDB Workspace
- Service Graph Connector Essentials & Discovery Fundamentals

6. Exam Structure & Registration

Format

- **Type:** Proctored (Pearson VUE center or Online via OnVUE).
- **Items:** 75 Questions.
- **Item Types:**
 - *Multiple Choice (Single Answer)*
 - *Multiple Select (Select all that apply)*
 - *Matching Items (Pairing terms/concepts)*
 - *Scenario-Based (Applied knowledge)*

Registration Process

1. **Register:** Via ServiceNow Webassessor/Learning portal. Payment or Learning Credits required.
2. **Schedule:** You have 90 days from registration to schedule and complete the exam.
3. **Retake Policy:** If failed, a waiting period and re-payment are required.

Results

- **Scoring:** Pass/Fail (Cut score is confidential).
- **Notification:** Immediate "Conditional" result upon completion.
- **Badge:** Credly digital badge issued upon passing.

7. Sample Questions

Question 1

The Configuration Management team wants to identify which CIs have been created from an asset but have not been discovered. The team creates a report on the target CI Class. How does the team identify these CIs in the report?

- A. All CIs with a Discovery source value of 'SNAssetManagement'
- B. All CIs with the Updated field older than a month
- C. All CIs where the Last Discovered field is empty
- D. All CIs with a Discovery source value of 'ServiceNow'

Answer: A (Discovery source value of 'SNAssetManagement')

Question 2

A State field is updated on an Asset record. Which fields are automatically synchronized on the associated CI record? (choose two)

- A. Operational status
- B. Install Status
- C. Hardware Status
- D. Asset tag

Answer: B, C (Install Status, Hardware Status)

Question 3 (Matching)

Put the structure of Playbooks in sequential order.

1. **Summary of indicator** (First)
2. **Overview of problem** (Second)
3. **Importance of addressing issue** (Third)
4. **Fix or Improve** (Fourth)